Forkcast — Financial Model

The brief version · July 2026

How the business earns money, in plain terms. Full assumptions available in the detailed model on request. A planning model, not a guarantee.

1 How we earn money — three streams, switched on in order

1. Diner subscriptions — from day one

The core experience is **free forever**: Fit Scores, discovery, ordering, and confirmed meal logging. Premium sells the personal science — adaptive calorie calibration, pattern analytics, unlimited photo AI:

	Monthly	Annual
Forkcast Premium	**$4.99**	**$39.99**
MyFitnessPal Premium (for comparison)	$19.99	$79.99

Both billing options exist; we steer to **annual** (it roughly halves churn). We win every price comparison on entry, and pricing headroom is upward as verified trust earns it.

2. Restaurant order commission — as volume proves out

6% only on pickup orders that start inside Forkcast. The fee is not for delivery — it pays for the *customer*: a health-driven diner we steered to that restaurant, tracked cleanly because the order flows through our checkout. DoorDash charges the same 6% on its pickup orders, so the price is already market-validated — except with us, verification tools, the order terminal, and allergy flags are **free**, and a diner who walks in without ordering through the app costs the restaurant nothing.

3. Featured placement & employer/insurer programs — later

Restaurants already receiving orders can buy clearly-labeled featured slots (from $99/mo) — which **never affect Fit Scores**. In later years, employers and insurers pay for covered nutrition programs. Both layer on top; neither is required for the model to work.

2 What five years look like (base case)

	Y1 (Boston)	Y2	Y3	Y4	Y5
Paying subscribers	3,000	25,000	90,000	220,000	450,000
Partner restaurant locations	40	400	1,500	4,000	9,000
Subscription revenue	$0.1M	$1.1M	$3.8M	$9.2M	$18.9M
Restaurant revenue	—	$0.4M	$1.6M	$4.2M	$9.5M
Employer/insurer revenue	—	—	$0.5M	$3.0M	$9.0M
Total revenue	**$0.2M**	**$1.5M**	**$5.9M**	**$16.4M**	**$37.4M**

Roughly half consumer, half business revenue by Year 5. Profitability arrives around Year 4–5. Bear case ~$21M; bull case $73M+.

3 The three numbers that matter

Number	Target	Plain meaning
Customer lifetime value vs. cost	**3.3 : 1**	A subscriber is worth ~$50 over their lifetime and costs ~$15 to acquire — partner restaurants promoting Forkcast to their own customers keep acquisition cheap
Payback period	**~6 months**	Marketing spend on a subscriber returns within half a year
Gross margin	**~82%**	Software economics; the free tier costs pennies per user to serve

4 Funding, simply

Raising ~$1.0–1.5M pre-seed to run the Boston pilot, sign the first verified restaurant partners, and prove retention — followed by a seed round (~$5M) once those numbers exist, and roughly $8M total before the business sustains itself. Government small-business research grants (SBIR) stack on top without dilution.

Discipline rules: growth spending stops whenever a subscriber cohort's economics fall below 3:1 value-to-cost; the restaurant fee stays performance-only until order volume earns more; and no revenue stream ever compromises the product's core promise — sponsorship can never change a Fit Score.

Companion to the Forkcast Business Plan (July 2026). Detailed assumptions, cost build, and scenarios available in the full Financial Model appendix.